

SAHARA MC765124-MK10

Media Center For The Living Room



Riding the Media Center wave comes Sahara's MK10. Finished in luxurious black with a huge brushed aluminium dial, it looks more like a DVD player than a Media Center PC.

The volume knob has a bright blue backlight and

could have been designed to move smoother. A blue-lit alphanumeric display is slotted on the front; it displays the status when playing media files. A pull-down flap covers the media control keys and also provides access to card readers and the other regular PC ports.

The media player has a functional IR for the remote control built in the front panel. An additional two

wire lead is provided which can be set at convenient angle allowing the remote to be used in a wider range

On the media front, the PC comes bundled with a TV-Tuner card, FM radio, a DVD player, and a 160 GB hard drive. There's onboard 7.1 audio for connecting a surround sound system; however, Sahara has only bundled an Altec Lansing 2.1 speaker set.

On the PC front, you have the Pentium D805 processor, which is good enough for media and typical PC usage. There's 512 MB of RAM, and a 17-inch LCD. The wireless keyboard is a cute piece of hardware with an inbuilt mouse tracker; we sorely missed a separate mouse.

Performance-wise, the integrated 945G provides playable frame rates in most

of games -not for serious gaming. The 16X DVD Writer dose a fine job of popping out burnt DVD's at a decent pace. The 7200 rpm SATA hard disk is fast enough for its intended use as a Media Centre PC.

At Rs 51,999 is hard to justify: you can get a powerful system for the same price. Still, the form factor is unique, and will blend well into the décor of a nice living room.

Specifications

Processor: Pentium D 805; motherboard: PIC PTM945G/P; 512 MB 533 MHz DDR2 RAM; 160 GB 7200 rpm SATA HDD, 16x DVD-RW; 17-inch 4:3 LCD monitor; 2.1 Altec Lansing 121i 20 W speakers; wireless keyboard with integrated tracker ball; IR remote; Hauppauge (Conexant chipset) TV-Tuner

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Price: Rs 51,999

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★
Features	★★★★
Ease of Use	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★

TOP UPS

Very Functional

In an increasingly "me-too" product world, the TOP-UPS stands apart. It adheres to the "Form should follow function" design philosophy perfectly.

Shaped like a small helmet, the TOP UPS has nifty features that enhance its usability. First, it has slots on top for storing CD cases. Second, there is a little flap in front with a bright white LED, which can act as a torch during power failures. Third, there is a digital

clock at the front. A small socket at the front provides an alternative way of charging cell phones.

Wipro has provided six different adapter plugs used by major cell phone



manufacturers such as Nokia and Sony Ericsson.

The operating range for the UPS is specified as 140 to 280V, and with a transfer time of below 10 ms the UPS kicks in during power failures. Two power outlets are driven via the battery, while other one is surge-protected and not driven off the battery. The colour coded power outlets eases installation. The maintenance-free battery is rated at 12V, 7AH is user-swappable.

On our test-bed consisting of a Pentium 4 3.06 GHz, Foxconn 945G7MA motherboard, and a 17-inch CRT, we got a backup time of 12 minutes—quite typical.

At Rs 3500, the TOP-UPS is priced higher than UPSes with similar specs. However, considering the extra features on offer, we think the price is justified, though we'd

have liked to see a better (read more sober) colour scheme.

Specifications

Dimensions: 184 (W) x 235 (D) x 236 (H) mm; weight: 6 kg; 600 VA, 360 W; supports cold start ;transfer time: <10ms; input voltage: 140 ~ 280 V; output voltage: 230 V ffl 5 per cent (battery); RJ11 port surge suppression; typical recharge time 6 hrs to 90 per cent capacity

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★
Features	★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★

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Price: Rs 3,500